Go/围棋 Introductory Course

Syllabus

1. Introduction to Go
    - Brief history and cultural significance of the game
    - Benefits of playing the game
    - Overview of the game board and stones
2. Basic Rules and Liberties
    - Explain the rules of placing stones on the intersections
    - Introduce the concept of liberties and capturing stones
    - Discuss the concept of life and death of groups of stones (IMPORTANT)
3. Board Setup and Opening Strategies
    - Explain the initial board setup (19x19, 13x13, 9x9)
    - Introduce common opening strategies and their purposes
4. Basic Tactics and Capturing Techniques
    - Teach basic capturing techniques such as atari and ladder
    - Introduce other tactical concepts like nets, false eyes, and ko fights
5. Territory and Influence
    - Explain the concept of territory and how to count it (Direct, Indirect and Captured)
    - Discuss the influence of stones on the board and its importance in strategy (ring of influence)
6. Midgame Strategy
    - Introduce concepts of thickness, influence, and reducing opponent's influence
    - Discuss strategic concepts like attacking, defending, and invading territories
7. Endgame and Scoring
    - Explain the transition from midgame to endgame
    - Teach how to count and score territories accurately (Japanese and Chinese counting system)
8. Practice and Game Analysis
    - Provide opportunities for students to practice playing games
    - Analyze and review games to identify strengths and weaknesses
9. Resources and Further Study
    - Provide recommended books, websites, and online resources for further study (use OGS)
    - Encourage participation in Go clubs, tournaments, and online communities (MWA, MWSA)

Note:

In a 4-hour course, the time allocated to each section is condensed, but the main concepts and practical aspects of the game are covered. It's important to prioritize hands-on practice during the session to reinforce the learning experience.

Day	Duration	Content
1	15m	Introduction to Go • Brief history and cultural significance of the game • Benefits of playing the game • Overview of the game board and stones
	30m	Basic Rules and Liberties • Explain the rules of placing stones on the intersections • Introduce the concept of liberties and capturing stones • Discuss the concept of life and death of groups of stones (IMPORTANT)
	15m	Practice and Game Analysis (1 of 4) • Provide opportunities for students to practice playing games • Analyze and review games to identify strengths and weaknesses
2	25m	Board Setup and Opening Strategies • Explain the initial board setup (19x19, 13x13, 9x9) • Introduce common opening strategies and their purposes
	20m	Basic Tactics and Capturing Techniques (1 of 2) • Teach basic capturing techniques such as atari and ladder • Introduce other tactical concepts like nets, false eyes, and ko fights
	15m	Practice and Game Analysis (2 of 4) • Provide opportunities for students to practice playing games • Analyze and review games to identify strengths and weaknesses
3	15m	Basic Tactics and Capturing Techniques (2 of 2) • Teach basic capturing techniques such as atari and ladder • Introduce other tactical concepts like nets, false eyes, and ko fights
	30m	Territory and Influence (30 minutes) • Explain the concept of territory and how to count it (Direct, Indirect and Captured)

		• Discuss the influence of stones on the board and its importance in strategy (ring of influence)
	15m	Practice and Game Analysis (3 of 4) • Provide opportunities for students to practice playing games • Analyze and review games to identify strengths and weaknesses
4	15m	Midgame Strategy (15 minutes) • Introduce concepts of thickness, influence, and reducing opponent's influence • Discuss strategic concepts like attacking, defending, and invading territories
	20m	Endgame and Scoring • Explain the transition from midgame to endgame • Teach how to count and score territories accurately (Japanese and Chinese counting system)
	20m	Practice and Game Analysis (4 of 4) • Provide opportunities for students to practice playing games • Analyze and review games to identify strengths and weaknesses
	5m	Resources and Further Study • Provide recommended books, websites, and online resources for further study (use OGS) • Encourage participation in Go clubs, tournaments, and online communities (MWA, MWSA)